



SHERIF ABAZA

Events Lead · Brand

CONTACT

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CORE SKILLS

Brand Event Production
Creative & Spatial Direction
Stakeholder Management
Team & Agency Leadership
Brand Strategy & Storytelling

EVENT FORMATS

Brand activations & sponsorships
Thought leadership forums
Public & consumer festivals
Corporate & conference programmes
Policy & government summits
Virtual & hybrid experiences

LANGUAGES

Arabic	Native
English	Native
French	Excellent
Spanish	Excellent
Dutch	Working
Polish	Working
Portuguese	Basic
Italian	Basic

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Engineering
Arab Academy for Science, Technology & Maritime
Transport, Alexandria

Sherif Abaza

Events Lead, Brand · Anthropic Application

sabaza@gmail.com +31 6 2306 3073 linkedin.com/in/sabaza Willing to Relocate · San Francisco / New York

PROFILE

Brand events specialist with 20+ years of experience designing, producing, and leading experiences that make complex ideas land in rooms. From founding a 140-person events agency in Dubai to delivering programmes at COP27, COP26, and COP29, my career has been defined by one constant: translating a brand's deepest convictions into physical and digital moments people remember.

I have worked across brand activations, thought leadership forums, policy summits, public festivals, and corporate conferences — managing everything from creative conceiving and spatial design to end-to-end production, vendor leadership, and post-event measurement. I build the playbooks and the teams that make quality scalable, and I am deeply comfortable with the kind of high-stakes, cross-functional environments where events carry real strategic weight.

EXPERIENCE

Abaza Business Services · Eindhoven, Netherlands / Global

Founder & Managing Director

2019 – Present

- End-to-end delivery of programmes at COP27 (Egypt), COP26 UAE side-events, and COP29 (Azerbaijan) — coordinating multinational teams across countries and time zones for the world's most demanding policy audiences.
- Designed and delivered multi-day conferences, innovation fairs, and global brand activations for international clients across Europe, MENA, and beyond.
- Served as strategic advisor on event design, logistics, and delivery — translating creative briefs into structured execution plans that held under pressure.
- Built operational frameworks enabling agile, high-quality delivery across multiple countries simultaneously.

Sphere Events and Communication · Dubai, UAE

Founder & Managing Director

2008 – 2013

- Founded and scaled a regional events and communications agency from a sole operator to a 140-person multinational team — covering production, design, logistics, and client servicing.
- Delivered 150+ projects annually at \$8M+ revenue, maintaining creative quality and client retention across Siemens, Ericsson, Emaar, and Porsche.
- Led major public brand activations including Street Nights, Dubai Chocolate Festival, and Marina Music Festival — managing audiences of tens of thousands.
- Developed the agency's operational playbooks, supplier networks, QA systems, and leadership culture from scratch.
- Oversaw all aspects of event identity development, spatial design, and experiential production end-to-end.

Withlocals B.V. · Eindhoven, Netherlands

Chief Growth Officer / Chief Community Officer

2018 – Present

- Scaled international brand and community presence across 80+ countries and 300+ cities.
- Led pivot to virtual experiences during COVID — designed and launched a proprietary platform serving 70+ global corporate clients in under 90 days.
- Partnered with Product and Engineering to build the tools and dashboards powering community performance and brand consistency at scale.

EARLIER ROLES

Senior Account Manager · ASDAA Burson-Marsteller, Dubai (2004–2006) — Key role in producing the inaugural Dubai International Film Festival; brand campaigns for Siemens, Adidas, and Hilton across the Middle East.

Business Development & Operations Manager · Sundance Events, Dubai (2004–2006) — Early foundation in event operations and client management.

CEO, MENA · FrontFlip (me360), Kansas City / Dubai (2010–2013) — Co-founded and led regional operations of a mobile loyalty startup; raised \$1.8M; built a 25-person cross-functional team.

Various Leadership Roles · AIESEC International (1999–2004) — Local Committee President and National Support roles; cross-cultural team leadership across multiple countries.